

Science vs religion



From its ancient Greek beginnings, Western philosophy set out to find rational explanations for things that were previously explained by religion. With the advent of Christianity, however, there was an uneasy relationship between reasoning and matters of faith, as philosophy challenged Church dogma. But it was 'natural philosophy' – what we now call science – that posed the greatest threat to the dominance of religion, and from the Renaissance onwards there was an increasing reliance on scientific explanations of the universe. By the 20th century, philosophers had generally accepted there can be no proof of the existence of God, and atheism became an acceptable standpoint. Western society has become generally more secular in recent years, Yet despite this, around three-quarters of the world still identify themselves as believers in some religion, and some fundamentalists, such as creationists, even reject scientific evidence in favour of divine revelation. Science may be vitally necessary to the modern world, but it would seem that religion is at least equally important.